

Luxor to Aswan (5 Nights / 6 Days)

Sail south along the legendary Nile on a journey through time, from the world's greatest open-air museum in Luxor to the graceful city of Aswan. This downstream itinerary allows you to explore the major highlights at a relaxed pace, concluding with the option of a breathtaking side trip to Abu Simbel.

- **Tips for Your Trip:** This itinerary involves significant walking at archaeological sites, often on uneven ground. Comfortable shoes, sun protection, and water are essential. The sailing schedule and overnight mooring locations are subject to change based on river and lock conditions

Day 1: Luxor – Arrival & East Bank Wonders

- **Embarkation:** Board your cruise ship in Luxor. Settle into your cabin and enjoy a welcome lunch on board.
- **Afternoon Tour:** Dive into history with a visit to the East Bank:
 - **Karnak Temple:** Explore the vast complex of temples, pylons, and obelisks dedicated to the Theban triad.
 - **Luxor Temple:** Discover this majestic temple located in the heart of the modern city, beautifully illuminated after dusk.
- **Evening:** Dinner and your first night on board, moored in Luxor.

East Bank: Karnak Temple



East Bank: Luxor Temple



Day 2: Luxor's West Bank & Sailing South

- **Morning Tour:** Cross the Nile to explore the **West Bank**, the necropolis of ancient Thebes:
 - **Valley of the Kings:** Descend into the tombs of pharaohs (typically visiting 3 tombs).
 - **Temple of Hatshepsut:** Admire the unique, terraced architecture of this mortuary temple at Deir el-Bahari.
 - **Colossi of Memnon:** See the two massive stone statues of Pharaoh Amenhotep III.
- **Afternoon Sail:** Begin your cruise south, passing through the **Esna Lock** (a fascinating navigational feat).
- **Evening:** Arrive and moor near the ancient site of El Kab.
- **Overnight:** Moored near El Kab.

Esna Lock



West Bank: Valley of the Kings & Queens



West Bank: Temple of Hatshepsut



West Bank: Colossi of Memnon



Day 3: El Kab & The Temple of Horus at Edfu

- **Morning Visit:** Explore the ruins of **El Kab**, an important pre-dynastic and Pharaonic settlement.
- **Midday Sail:** Cruise to Edfu.
- **Afternoon Visit:** Travel by horse-drawn carriage to the magnificent **Temple of Edfu**, one of Egypt's best-preserved monuments, dedicated to the falcon god Horus.
- **Evening Sail:** Continue your journey to the mooring site at Gebel El Silsila.
- **Overnight:** Moored near El Silsila.

Temple of Horus



El Kab



Day 4: Gebel El Silsila & The Dual Temple of Kom Ombo

- **Morning Visit:** Discover **Gebel El Silsila**, the ancient sandstone quarry site with impressive rock-cut shrines and stelae on the riverbanks.
- **Midday Sail:** Cruise to Kom Ombo.
- **Afternoon Visit:** Tour the unique **Temple of Kom Ombo**, symmetrically dedicated to both the crocodile god Sobek and the falcon god Horus.
- **Evening Sail:** Enjoy your final stretch of sailing as you head towards Aswan.
- **Overnight:** Moored in Aswan.

The Dual Temple of Sobek & Haroeris



El Silsila Quarry & Riverside Shrines



Gebel El-Silsila



Day 5: Aswan's Treasures & Abu Simbel Option

- **Full-Day with Two Options:**
 - **Option 1 (Classic Aswan Tour):**
 - **Morning:** Visit the sublime **Philae Temple**, dedicated to the goddess Isis, located on an island.
 - **Afternoon:** See the modern **High Dam**, the original **Old Dam**, and the **Unfinished Obelisk** in the ancient granite quarries.
 - **Option 2 (Abu Simbel Highlight):**
 - **Very Early Morning:** Depart for an unforgettable excursion (by plane or convoy) to the colossal rock-cut **Temples of Abu Simbel**.
 - **Afternoon Return to Aswan:** Upon return, visit **Philae Temple**, the **High Dam**, **Old Dam**, and **Unfinished Obelisk**.
- **Evening:** Farewell dinner and final night on board in Aswan.

Philae Temple



High Dam



Old Aswan Dam



Unfinished Obelisk



Abu Simbel Temple



Day 6: Aswan – Disembarkation

Morning: After breakfast on board, disembark at your leisure in Aswan, marking the end of your cruise

- **Travel Notes:** This itinerary provides a general framework; the order of visits on specific days may be adjusted by your tour operator. Comfortable walking shoes, sun protection, and water are essential for daily excursions